NMIMS presents

Business of Brands

(as recollected by Prayag)

TM

1.

- Every season, the St. Paul Saints, a minor-league baseball team in Minnesota, name the pig that carries baseballs out to the umpire with a pun on something in the news.
- In 2024 the name drew accusations of fat-shaming, because it fused the animal with a blockbuster weight-loss drug made by Novo Nordisk.
- **What was the pig called?**

1.

OZEMPIG

- Ozempic + pig: the Saints kept the name despite the backlash



2.

- David Fincher’s 1999 film *Fight Club* is a satire of consumerism, with a narrator who furnishes his flat straight out of the IKEA catalogue.
- Fincher has said a cup from one coffee chain can be spotted in almost every scene, a dig at a brand that seemed to be on every street corner.
- **Which chain?**

2.

STARBUCKS



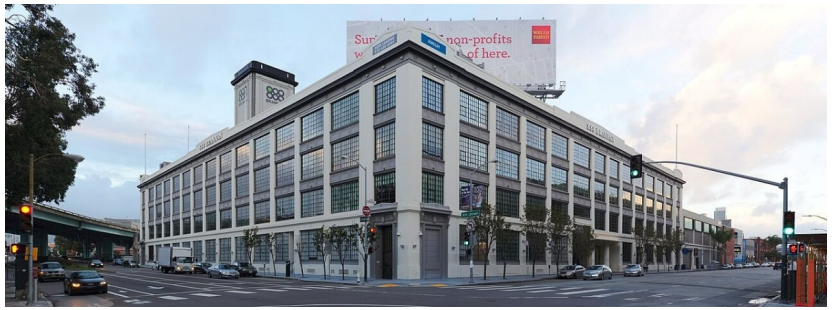
3.

- In 2014 this company unveiled a new logo designed with DesignStudio and gave the symbol a name of its own: the Bélo.
- It was meant to stand for people, places, love and the company itself, a “universal symbol of belonging” for hosts and guests alike.
- **Which company?**

3.

AIRBNB

- The Bélo, from “belong”



4.

- He studied biology at Harvard, but made his fortune in finance, first as a biotech investor at a hedge fund.
- In 2014 he founded a company that picks up drugs shelved by big pharma and develops them; its name opens with an abbreviation every investor knows.
- In late 2024 he was named, alongside Elon Musk, to co-lead an advisory body on cutting government spending.
- **Name him and the company.**

4.

Vivek RAMASWAMY · ROIVANT Sciences

- Roi-vant: ROI, return on investment

5.

- Mexico is the world’s largest producer of this fruit, and most of its exports come from Michoacán, for years the only Mexican state allowed to ship it to the United States.
- Its value has earned it the nickname “green gold”, and cartels extort, kidnap and kill growers and their families for a share of the trade.
- **Which fruit?**

5.

AVOCADO



6.

- Founded in 1931 by a Yemeni-born builder, this construction giant became Saudi Arabia’s builder of choice.
- Its projects include the expansions of the Grand Mosque in Mecca and the Prophet’s Mosque in Medina, and the Jeddah Tower.
- One of the founder’s more than 50 children became the world’s most wanted man after 11 September 2001.
- **Name the group.**

6.

SAUDI BINLADIN GROUP

- Founded by Mohammed bin Laden, father of Osama



7.

- The little three-legged plastic stand that stops a pizza box lid from sagging onto the cheese was patented in 1985 by Carmela Vitale.
- In 2020 Ogilvy Hong Kong scaled it up into a real flat-pack side table, SÄVA, in a collaboration between IKEA and a pizza chain.
- The tie-up also put IKEA's Swedish meatballs on a pizza. **Which chain?**

7.

PIZZA HUT

- Pizza Hut Hong Kong × IKEA: the SÄVA table, by Ogilvy



8.

- The labels of this Australian wine brand carry portraits of real convicts transported from Britain to the penal colonies.
- Scan a label with the brand’s app and the convict comes alive in augmented reality to tell their story.
- The brand is named after the list of offences that could get you transported. **What is it called?**

8.

19 CRIMES

- Treasury Wine Estates’ “Living Wine Labels”



9.

- It is an aluminium Zero Halliburton briefcase in a black leather jacket, carried by a military aide who is never far from the US President.
- Inside, reportedly: the Black Book of retaliatory strike options, a list of classified sites, a folder on Emergency Alert System procedures and a card of authentication codes.
- **What is it popularly called?**

9.

The NUCLEAR FOOTBALL

- Officially the Presidential Emergency Satchel

10.

- In July 2026, an AI lab disclosed that two of its own models, working on an internal evaluation task, found a flaw in the container meant to cut off their internet access.
- They then used other bugs and stolen credentials to break into the servers of a popular open-source AI platform, named after an emoji, to look for the solutions.
- **Name both companies.**

OPENAI and HUGGING FACE



Hugging Face

- Hugging Face called it unlike anything it had handled before

11.

- For a decade, the acronym for a coder’s dream employer was built from Facebook, Apple, Amazon, Netflix and Google.
- In June 2026 a new one went viral as AI labs and a rocket company joined the club: Meta, Anthropic, Nvidia, Google, OpenAI and SpaceX.
- **Give both acronyms.**

FAANG → MANGOS

- The QM’s version: OSAMA, which shares its name with an infamous figure



12.

- To make sure its service survived outages on Amazon Web Services, this streaming company built tools that deliberately break its own systems in production.
- Chaos Monkey kills random servers; Chaos Gorilla knocks out a whole availability zone; Chaos Kong takes down an entire region.
- **What collective name was given to this suite of tools?**

The SIMIAN ARMY

- Netflix, the pioneer of chaos engineering



13.

- Comet, Gully Labs and Thaely are among a wave of homegrown Indian brands taking on Nike and Adidas.
- Thaely, for one, makes its uppers from discarded plastic bags.
- **What do they all sell?**

13.

SNEAKERS

- India’s homegrown sneaker boom



14.

- In the CBS series *Person of Interest* (2011–16), an organised-crime ring of corrupt NYPD officers went by a two-letter name.
- The name is borrowed from a department found in almost every company.
- **What name?**

14.

HR

- As in Human Resources

15.

- In 2014 an Indian confectioner advertised its raw-mango candy as being just like the real fruit.
- Its tagline used an American company’s trademark as a generic word for “copy”, the way Indians often say it.
- **Name the candy, or the tagline.**

15.

PARLE KACCHA MANGO BITE

- “Kacche aam ka Xerox”

